

TEAM WORKING AGREEMENT

The Northstar Sprint - Support Deflection MVP

1. Team Identity

Field	Detail
Team / Pod Name	Northstar Support Pod
Client	Northstar Retail Co.
Sprint duration	5 working days (Monday–Friday)
Product goal	Build a demoable Support Deflection MVP covering at least 2 of 3 ticket types (order status, returns/refunds, stock availability).
Team size	4 members

2. Communication Norms

- **Primary channel:** WhatsApp group for all day-to-day coordination and live status updates.
- **Stand-up:** Daily at 7:30 PM for our meetings. Each person answers:
 1. What I completed since last stand-up
 2. What I am doing today
 3. Blockers
- **Availability:** Core working hours are 6:00 PM – 10:00 PM (EAT/SAST). Members outside these hours should notify the team in advance. Notify the group at least 30 minutes in advance if you will be unavailable during core hours.
- **Response time:** Acknowledge urgent messages within 30 minutes during core hours. Respond to non-urgent messages within 12 hours.
- **Respectful communication:** Team members will communicate professionally, respect different opinions, and provide constructive feedback at all times.
- **Meeting notes:** The person who raises a decision records the outcome in the shared notes in the WhatsApp group.

3. Deadlines & Commitments

- **Anti-black-box rule:** No board task may exceed 4 hours of work. Any task larger than 4 hours is split into smaller tasks before it is assigned.
- **Definition of Done:** Every task must have a single checkable sentence. If the DoD cannot

be checked with a yes/no question, rewrite it.

- **Same-day board updates:** Every task status is moved to the correct column on the same day the work is done. No end-of-week batch updates.
- **Version Control:** Every member will work on a separate branch, make descriptive commits, and submit changes through Pull Requests before merging into the main branch.
- **Commit/edit convention:** Every time you save or upload your code (a "commit"), your message must follow this exact format: state the *kind* of change, *what* you did, and *why* it's important.
- **End-of-day check-in:** Report what you completed today, what you are working on next, and any problems blocking you (if any).

4. Conflict Resolution

- **Direct conversation:** Raise the issue with the teammate privately and immediately after the concern arises.
- **Mediated conversation:** If unresolved, escalate to the full pod within 2 hours. Use a 15-minute structured conversation: each person states their view, then the group decides.
- **Facilitator:** If the pod cannot reach agreement, appoint a neutral rotating facilitator for the next conversation. The facilitator's decision is final for the sprint.
- **No silent disagreement:** If a decision affects your work and you disagree, speak up before the work starts. Silence is treated as agreement.

5. Escalation & Accountability

- **Zero-activity rule:** If any teammate shows no visible board, commit, or edit activity for 2 consecutive days, the escalation path is triggered immediately, not at the deadline.
- **Escalation path:**
 1. Direct check-in via primary channel
 2. If no response within 2 hours, full team call
 3. If still unresolved, notify the sprint facilitator
- **Contribution balance:** On Day 4 the team reviews the commit/edit plus board timestamp log. If one person is under-contributing, the team reallocates tasks transparently.
- **Peer Reliability Index:** Confidential, submitted individually at sprint end. Raw scores are never shared verbatim; only aggregate patterns may be discussed.

6. Quality & Handoff Standards

- **Code Testing:** All code must be tested before being merged into the main branch.
- **Definition of Done Satisfaction:** Every completed task must satisfy its Definition of Done before being marked complete.
- **Documentation Maintenance:** Documentation (README, Team Charter, Go-Live Readiness Note) must be updated whenever relevant changes are made.
- **Peer Reviews:** Pull Requests should be reviewed by at least one teammate before merging.
- **Final Deliverables:** The final repository must include a working prototype, project

documentation, audit trail, and clear setup instructions so the client can continue using the project without the team present.

7. Team Member Signatures

By signing below, each team member agrees to follow this Team Working Agreement for the duration of the Northstar Sprint.

Name	Role / Focus Area	Signature & Date
Collins Rotich	Team Lead / Repository & Integration	CKR (13/08/2026)
Cindy Manga	Frontend / Order Status	CM (13/08/2026)
Joseph Nguma	Backend / Returns & Refunds	JKN (13/08/2026)
Lerato Phelane	Documentation & Testing	LP (13/08/2026)